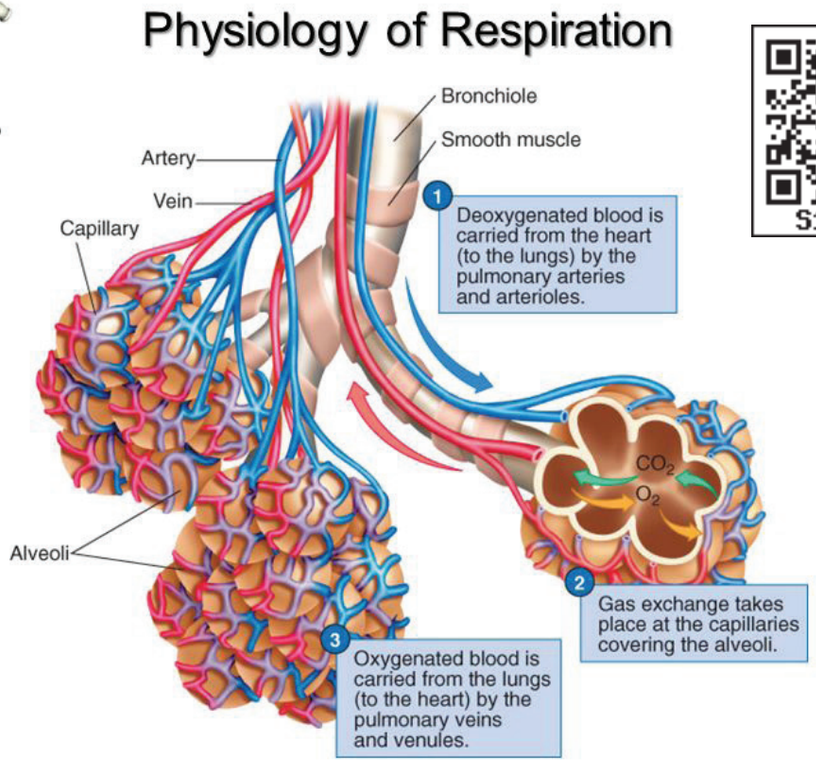




The most important factor in the control of ventilation is the level of CO_2 in the blood. An elevation of CO_2 in arterial blood causes the respiratory control system in the brain to increase the rate and depth of breathing.

Normal Respiratory Rate	
Age	**Respiration Rate**
< 1 Year	30–40
1–2 Years	25–35
2–5 Years	25–30
5–12 Years	20–25
> 12 Years	12–20



Assessment of respiration depends on

Look for chest and abdomen movement.

Listen and feel for airflow at the mouth and nose.

Factors which regulate respiration:

- Respiratory center in the medulla.
- Nerve fibers of the autonomic nervous system.
- Chemical composition of blood.

Procedure:

- Keep the patient in a relaxed and comfortable position.
- Try to count the respirations without the patient knowing that you are watching him or he may change the rate of respiration.
- Keep the fingers on the patient's wrist, as if for counting pulse and watch the rise and fall of the chest and abdomen or if the patient is sitting watch the movements of the shoulders.
- Chart the rate and record any abnormalities.

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